

MOVIE

Mortal Kombat

★★★★☆ | Mortal Kombat is one of our favourite franchises in all of pop culture. So, when we sat down to watch the much-anticipated reboot of the franchise, we were walking in with a lot of expectations. The trailer was excellent and really sold the film. So, is Mortal Kombat (2020) any good? Well, the answer is kind of complicated.

The first thing that really caught our attention was the fight choreography. In the trailer, the fight choreography was cut in such a way that it hinted at much more. Right from the start, something felt off. The editing



was choppy, with close up after close up, not giving us a good wide-angle of what these martial artists are doing. The camera always cuts away

at the wrong time. There is no kinetic energy in the fight choreography. The intro was not great but we were still willing to give the film the benefit of the doubt.

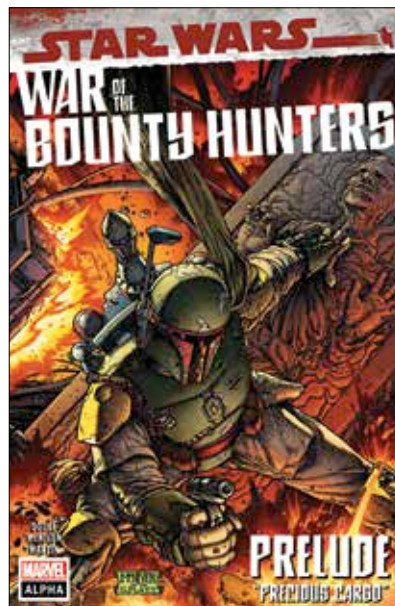
However, just some time into the film, our disappointment was immeasurable. The only high point so far was the costumes. Even the sets were so bland. Unlike the first film where we had incredible vistas, locations and set pieces that it really gave off the vibe of an actual adventure. Even Outworld looked cool in sub-standard CGI.

If you're a fan of the franchise, you could watch the film just for the costumes but for anyone looking for a good action/adventure film with great fight choreography and a focused story should definitely give this film a miss. Also, did we mention that the remixed version of the theme song was only used once! ONCE!

COMIC

Star Wars: War of the Bounty Hunters Alpha

★★★★☆ | When you hear about a new Star Wars comic series by Marvel, the knee jerk reaction is to wonder what it will tie into, and right off the bat the new series ties into Star Wars: Darth Vader, Star Wars: Doctor Aphra, Star Wars: Bounty Hunters and Star Wars which all take place between Ep V and VI. We understand more about the events that took place after Luke Skywalker finds out that Darth Vader is his father, and loses his lightsaber along with the hand, and we find out more about the missions of the Rebel Alliance, along with the other forces at play. This is Darth Vader at the peak of his powers, and is borderline a mythical paranormal force instead of something that exists strictly in the natural realm. We knew this series



was going to throw us right into the thick of the action at a very important time in the series before even starting to read, and we were not disappointed at all. The first panel is the Slave I, piloted by Bobba Fett, heading towards Jabba's Palace with Han Solo frozen in carbonite as the cargo. So that is the story that Star Wars: War of the Bounty Hunters Alpha is telling, and who would not want to read a story about Boba Fett. The comics have a

hulking, powerful, imposing yet surprisingly agile Fett, along similar lines as the depiction of the character by Robert Rodriguez in The Mandalorian. The trouble is that Han Solo's frozen body is quite the prize, and everyone will be looking for it. Bobba has instructions from Jabba to keep Solo alive, but you know Bobba does not really care about that too much. This is a story much bigger than Bobba Fett, who just triggers The War of the Bounty Hunters when he freezes Han Solo's body. The issues of all the other four ongoing comics in the same period are going to tell different bits and pieces of the story, making the event pretty big bada boom. Buuuut it gets bigger. Thing is, just like the other series, the story is not strictly kept to that time frame, the links to the current canon grows deeper with every panel, and you keep getting many tidbits of story that spans the entire saga. You never know which character, location or event will appear in the next page, which makes the page turning surprising and exciting. Despite the staggering scale of the story about to be told, there are hints of something even bigger. The Bounty hunters seem to obey no rules including operating within the same galaxy.